

3.2.3 Health, fitness and wellbeing

Students should develop knowledge and understanding of the benefits of participating in physical activity and sport to health, fitness and wellbeing.

3.2.3.1 Physical, emotional and social health, fitness and wellbeing

Content	Additional information
Linking participation in physical activity, exercise and sport to health, wellbeing and fitness, and how exercise can suit the varying needs of different people	Reasons for participation in physical activity, exercise and sport, and how performance in physical activity/sport can increase health, wellbeing and fitness. Physical health and wellbeing: • improves heart function • improves efficiency of the body systems • reduces the risk of some illness • able to do everyday tasks • to avoid obesity. Mental health and wellbeing: • reduces stress/tension • release of feel good hormones (serotonin) • able to control emotions. Social health and wellbeing: • opportunities to socialise/make friends • cooperation • teamwork • have essential human needs (food, shelter, clothing). Fitness: • improves fitness • reduces the chances of injury • can aid in the physical ability to work, eg on your feet all day/manual labour.

3.2.3.2 The consequences of a sedentary lifestyle

Content	Additional information
The consequences of a sedentary lifestyle	Definitions of sedentary and lifestyle. Possible consequences of a sedentary lifestyle: • weight gain/obesity • heart disease • hypertension • diabetes • poor sleep • poor self-esteem • lethargy.

Content	Additional information
Obesity and how it may affect performance in physical activity and sport	Definition of obesity. Obesity and how it may affect performance in physical activity and sport: • limits stamina/cardiovascular endurance • limits flexibility • limits agility • limits speed/power. Causes ill health (physical): • cancer • heart disease/heart attacks • diabetes • high cholesterol. Causes ill health (mental): • depression • loss of confidence. Causes ill health (social): • inability to socialise • inability to leave home.
Somatotypes	Definitions of the following body types: • endomorph • mesomorph • ectomorph. Students should be taught to identify the most suitable body type for particular sports (or positions within a sport) and justify their choice.

3.2.3.3 Energy use, diet, nutrition and hydration

Content	Additional information
Energy use	Energy is measured in calories (Kcal) and is obtained from the food we eat. The average adult male requires 2,500 Kcal/day and the average adult female requires 2,000 Kcal/day but this is dependent upon: • age • gender • height • energy expenditure (exercise).

Content	Additional information
Nutrition – reasons for having balanced diet	There is no single food that contains all the nutrients the body needs. A balanced diet contains lots of different types of food to provide the suitable nutrients, vitamins and minerals required. The reasons for a balanced diet: • unused energy is stored as fat, which could cause obesity (particularly saturated fat) • suitable energy can be available for activity • the body needs nutrients for energy, growth and hydration.
Nutrition – the role of carbohydrates, fat, protein and vitamins/minerals	A balanced diet contains 55–60% carbohydrate, 25–30% fat, 15–20% protein. Carbohydrates are the main and preferred energy source for all types of exercise, of all intensities. Fat is also an energy source. It provides more energy than carbohydrates but only at low intensity. Protein is for growth and repair of muscle tissue. Vitamins and minerals are for maintaining the efficient working of the body systems and general health. Students do not need to be taught about specific vitamins and minerals.

Content	Additional information
Reasons for maintaining water balance (hydration)	Definition of dehydration. Water balance (hydration) prevents dehydration. Dehydration results in: • blood thickening (increased viscosity), which slows blood flow • increases in heart rate/heart has to work harder/irregular heart rate (rhythm) • increase in body temperature/overheat • slowing of reactions/increased reaction time/poorer decisions • muscle fatigue/cramps. Students should be taught to understand and evaluate the consequences of dehydration to performance in different sporting activities.